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Lakshmi Narasimha swamy temple, Penna Ahobilam

The *Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple'* in Penna Ahobilam (often also spelled “Pennahobilam”) is a Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Narasimha, located in the Anantapur district of Andhra Pradesh, India.[1]

Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple, Penna Ahobilam	
Temple gopuram at Penna Ahobilam	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Anantapur
Deity	Lord Narasimha
Location	
Location	Penna Ahobilam
State	Andhra Pradesh
Country	India
Location in Andhra Pradesh	
Coordinates	14.8603°N 77.3065°E
Architecture	
Type	Vijayanagara style (regional variant)
Completed	15th century (major renovation)

Location

Penna Ahobilam is approximately 12 km from Uravakonda and about 36 km from Anantapur.[1] The temple is built on a hill, at an elevation of about 2800 feet (853 m) above sea level, in the Vijayanagara architectural style.[1] The complex lies near the Penna rivulet and is accessible from surrounding towns by road.[1]

Legend and history

Penna Ahobilam is considered one of the Swayambhu (self-manifested) Narasimha kshetras in Andhra Pradesh.[2] According to district records, the temple was built in the year 1478 of the Salivahana era by Sri Krishna Devarayala (Sadashivaraya) on a hill near Uravakonda.[2] Legend narrates that the sage Uddālaka once performed penance on the hill; in the lower area of the hill was a village named Gollapally, where a cow used to give milk daily into a well, until one day it was found empty. The local belief is that Lord Narasimha then appeared and declared that He would take the cow.[2] The name "Ahobilam" is believed to originate from the phrase *Aho Balam* (“What power!”), referring to the divine strength of the Lord.[1]

The sanctum enshrines a footprint (or impression) of Lord Narasimha, measuring 5 feet 3 inches.[3] In 1472 A.D., the Vijayanagara king Sadashivaraya is credited with installing a large idol and expanding the

Elevation	428 m (1,404 ft)

temple.[3] A subterranean tunnel beneath the sanctum is believed to channel the *theertham* used in daily *abhisheka* to flow into the Penna river, leaving no water in the tank at the temple.[3] On the temple walls, inscriptions refer to rulers such as the Chalukya king Kirtivarman II, suggesting that parts of the site may date to earlier periods (8th to 16th centuries).[1] A feature known as Narasimha Bugga (a fissure under tree roots) is associated with lore that water emanates from it, connected to the moment of the divine battle.[1]

Temple features

The main shrine houses the deity Sri Lakshmi Narasimha. Adjacent is a shrine for Udbhava Mahalakshmi, believed to have sprung from rock.[1] About 2 km downhill lies Rakthakundam, a pond where it is believed Lord Narasimha washed his hands after slaying the demon.[1] The temple exhibits architectural elements consistent with the Vijayanagara style, including gopurams, mandapas, and subsidiary shrines.[1]

Rituals, timings and festivals

Timings

- Morning darshan: 6:00 am to 1:00 pm[1] - Afternoon/evening: 2:00 pm to 7:00 pm[1] These timings are generally followed, though in local sources alternate timing windows are mentioned.[1]

Festivals and events

The annual car festival (Rātham) is held in the month of April, drawing many devotees.[1] The temple is also a popular venue for marriage rituals, as devotees believe blessings here support marital wellbeing.[1]

Significance and visitors

Penna Ahobilam is one of the prominent Narasimha kshetras in Andhra Pradesh, complementing the more famous Ahobilam in Kurnool district.[2] Visitors often combine pilgrimage with exploring nearby natural features (streams, falls) especially during monsoon or post-monsoon when water flows are stronger.[3]

Gallery

Temple at hilltop

Entrance

Mandapa on hill

Pillar at lower part

Lower hill view

Inscription

References

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3. "Penna Ahobillam Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple Timings, History" (https://templesinindiainfo.com/penna-ahobilam-lakshmi-narasimha-swamy-temple-timings-history/). 20 December 2019. Retrieved 5 October 2025.

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